Releasing the Trauma of Childhood Mistakes

As you go deeper into this gentle hypnotic rest, your subconscious mind is open and receptive to the suggestions it is about to receive.

And now that you are feeling deeply relaxed, I want you to settle into a comfortable position, allowing yourself to be present with the words I am going to be saying, letting them flow into the parts of your mind that are ready to listen, to soften and to gently grow.

And as you listen, you may notice your mind drifting in and out, letting the ideas settle in their own way, at their own pace. Nothing needs to be forced. Nothing needs to be perfect. This entire experience is a place where you are already safe enough to just *be*.

This session is here to support you in releasing old patterns that came from times in your life when mistakes didn't feel safe, times when you may have learned, consciously or unconsciously, that errors meant punishment, shame, yelling or fear.

You don't need to think about any specific memory. You don't need to revisit anything. You can simply acknowledge that somewhere in your past, you absorbed the message that perfection equalled safety, that trying to be flawless somehow protected you from harm.

And now, as an adult, you may notice the echoes of those old lessons still humming in the background. The fear of disappointing people. The pressure to get everything right. The tension that rises in the body at the thought of making a mistake.

And even though you're older now, even though you've grown, learned, survived and become someone far stronger than you once were, that old pattern sometimes still reacts as if the world is dangerous, as if being imperfect could lead to punishment again.

But today, you can rewrite that inner experience. Not by erasing the past, not by pretending it didn't shape you, but by giving yourself new choices, a new internal reality, a

new way of relating to mistakes, to growth, to safety and to your own humanity.

So let yourself imagine, if you like, a gentle bubble around you. A soft, flexible shield in your mind, one that only you can see and belongs only to you.

You can sense the atmosphere of safety that this bubble provides - an atmosphere where nothing bad can happen, where you are not judged, where mistakes are not dangerous - where errors are simply part of being human.

Let yourself relax in this bubble, noticing the comfort it brings.

You may imagine a soft light filling the inside of the bubble around you, a warm golden glow or a tranquil coolness that eases the muscles and quiets the mind.

In this bubble, perfection isn't needed. You can breathe freely here. This space is an inner refuge - created by you, for you - and it remains with you always.

As you stand or sit in this bubble that is your internal sanctuary, allow your mind to sense a younger version of you nearby, also within this bubble. Not a specific age. Not a specific memory. Just a symbolic representation of the younger self who learned to fear mistakes. The version of you who felt pressure to be perfect. The one who believed the world would fall apart if they weren't careful enough, quiet enough, good enough, flawless enough.

You don't have to see this younger self clearly. You might just sense their presence. Feel their emotions. Hear their quiet longing for safety and acceptance.

And notice how much compassion naturally rises within you as you recognize how hard that younger self tried - how much effort they put into surviving, staying safe, protecting themselves the only way they knew how.

You may feel warmth in your chest, a tug of empathy, or simply a gentle awareness. There is no right or wrong way to experience this moment. You are simply acknowledging the child within you who had to be perfect, who had to avoid mistakes to avoid pain.

child within you who had to be perfect, who had to avoid mistakes to avoid pain.

And notice how that child did the best they could with the world they lived in. They adapted brilliantly. They survived.

In this internal bubble, imagine yourself approaching this younger version of you slowly, kindly, with a softness that radiates from the centre of your being.

If it feels right, you might imagine offering a gentle hand, or sitting beside them, or simply kneeling to meet them at eye level. You don't need words yet. Just presence.

Feel what it's like to be the supportive adult you always needed - calm, warm and stable. The adult who doesn't punish mistakes. The adult who celebrates effort. The adult who understands that perfection isn't possible or necessary. The adult who knows that mistakes are part of learning, growth and courage.

And in this bubble of safety, imagine saying to your younger self:

"It wasn't your fault. You were doing the best you could. You didn't deserve fear or punishment. Mistakes never meant that you were bad. You were a child who deserved kindness and understanding."

Give those words time to settle into the air around you both, into the younger self near you and into your own deeper mind. Notice how they change something. Notice how the atmosphere relaxes.

Now imagine a gentle bond forming between you and this younger self. Perhaps it shows itself as a light, perhaps warm, golden and healing.

This bond is understanding. It's compassion. It's safety. It's a boundary between the past and the present. It symbolizes that you, right now, are the protector. You are the safe adult. You are the one with the power to reshape how you respond to the world.

Let that bond grow and fill the entire bubble. Imagine it comforting the younger self,

soothing them, wrapping around them like a blanket of reassurance. And as it glows brighter, feel the truth of this: The danger is gone. The punishment is over. The fear no longer applies to the world you live in.

Now imagine the younger version of you relaxing - shoulders softening, breath deepening, fear melting. See or sense that child finally receiving the kindness they always deserved. See them gradually feeling safe enough to let go of the weight they carried. And notice how, as they release that old fear, you - your adult self - also feel something loosening inside.

You might notice tension easing in your chest. Tightness dissolving around your mind. A burden lifted from your shoulders. A softening in your throat or heart. Perhaps even a warm glow of relief spreading through your body. This is the beginning of releasing perfectionism at its root: not as a behavior to fix, but as a long-standing fear that is finally being soothed.

Now imagine the younger self handing something symbolic back to you - a heavy object, a dark shape, a stone or a weight - something that represents the burden they were forced to carry.

Whatever appears is right - see them offer it to you - not because you must carry it, but because you are the one who can finally set it down.

Take that symbol gently. Feel its weight for a moment, the emotional history behind it, the years you have had to carry it, the years of fear, pressure and self-blame that it represents.

Then imagine turning toward a stream of water, a fire, a glowing orb of light - wherever feels like the right place for releasing. And place that burden into it.

Watch it dissolve. Melt. Disappear. Transform. And as it does, feel that the hold it had on your adult life dissolves with it. That old belief - “I must be perfect to be safe” - begins to unwind from deep within your subconscious.

A new belief begins to form in its place:

“I am safe now. Mistakes are part of being human. My worth is not measured by perfection. I am allowed to show up as I am.”

Repeat these words to yourself slowly, letting them drift into your deeper mind. You may even realise that some part of you deep down already knew that they were true, and the rest of you feels drawn to them, and breathes easier because of them.

Now imagine the younger self rising, lighter, unburdened, looking at you with trust. They may smile, rest against you, or simply radiate ease. And imagine you saying to this younger self:

“You don’t need to protect me anymore. You can rest now. I will take care of us from here.”

Feel the change as the younger self dissolves gently into your heart, integrating into the adult you - no longer a wounded child trying to keep you safe through perfection, but a healed part of your inner world that can finally relax.

And now, turn your attention to your adult self - here, in this bubble of sanctuary, in this moment - feeling the freedom of new possibilities.

Imagine future situations in which you make small mistakes and feel calm. Perhaps you see yourself shrugging lightly, understanding that errors do not define you.

You may picture yourself receiving feedback gracefully or trying something new without fear.

Notice how empowering it feels to release pressure.

You learn that mistakes are part of being human and also an important source of valuable lessons.

Making mistakes shows us that we need to try a different way, and in doing so, we learn so

much.

Imagine future conversations where you allow yourself to be human. Days where you choose progress over perfection. Moments where you breathe through the discomfort and choose self-kindness instead of self-criticism.

Visualize yourself interacting with others - friends, co-workers, partners - and feeling happy in the awareness that disappointing someone is not dangerous, that disagreement is not punishment and that your worth is stable and strong, regardless of how perfect you appear.

See yourself smiling more often, laughing at small mistakes, giving yourself permission to learn. Imagine your body relaxing naturally because you are no longer bracing for punishment that will never come.

And in this visualization of your future, notice how much energy you reclaim when you let go of constant vigilance. Notice how much lighter your life becomes when you release old rules that were never yours to begin with. Notice how much more authentic you feel when you no longer have to perform or hide.

Let these images soak into your subconscious, becoming pathways your mind can access in daily life. Feel the way they improve your identity - from someone who had to be perfect to someone who is free to be whole.

Now, feel yourself being comforted by safety, self-compassion and the permission to be imperfect.

Because you are safe now, you no longer need perfection to feel worthy, and mistakes are part of growth.

You choose self-kindness over fear. You trust yourself to handle whatever comes. You are free to be human.

Feel the truth of those words flowing through your body, your thoughts, your emotions. Let them take root in the quiet, inner places where real change begins. And know that each day forward, these new beliefs will continue to grow - naturally, gently, at your own pace.

In a moment or two, I am going to bring you back to full awakening consciousness.

As you come out of hypnosis, you will awaken with a sense of clarity and perspective.

Knowing that you are no longer living in the world that taught you to fear mistakes. You are living in a new inner reality - one where you are safe, confident and free.

For you have embarked on a journey of self-discovery and empowerment that opens the door to a happier, healthier and more fulfilling life.

And these suggestions are firmly embedded in your subconscious mind and grow stronger and stronger, day by day.

They grow stronger by the day, stronger by the hour, stronger by the minute.

In a moment, I will count the numbers from one to five, and at the count of five, you will be wide awake, fully alert and refreshed, and ready to allow these suggestions to work for you.

So, when you are ready, I want you to start coming back:

One, two, three, coming slowly back, four, eyelids beginning to flutter, and five, eyes open, wide awake, mind and body returning to normal conscious awareness.